

Chapter 3

Worksheet

Instructions:

Please complete all activities in this worksheet. Write your answers in the spaces provided or on separate sheets if needed.

Worksheet for Chapter 3: Communication Across Cultures

Objective: To help students understand and apply concepts of verbal and non-verbal communication, high-context vs. low-context cultures, active listening skills, and strategies for overcoming language barriers through reflection, activities, and critical thinking.

Part 1: Verbal and Non-Verbal Communication

Instructions: Reflect on how communication goes beyond words. Answer the following questions with 2-3 sentences each, using examples from the chapter or your own life.

- **Verbal Communication:** How can tone or word choice differ across cultures? Mention an example, like the use of “ji” in India for respect, or something you’ve noticed.
- **Non-Verbal Communication:** Describe a non-verbal cue (like body language or gestures) that varies across cultures, such as the Indian head bobble or eye contact differences. Have you ever seen or used one?

Part 2: High-Context vs. Low-Context Cultures

Instructions: Think about the differences between indirect and direct communication styles. Complete the table below by providing an example of how a message might be conveyed in each style for the given scenario.

Scenario: Telling a friend you can’t hang out today.

Culture Type	How the Message Might Be Said
High-Context (e.g., India)	
Low-Context (e.g., U.S.)	

Culture Type

How the Message Might Be Said

High-Context (e.g., India)

Low-Context (e.g., U.S.)

Reflection Question: Why might someone from a high-context culture misunderstand a low-context communicator, or vice versa? (2-3 sentences)

Part 3: Active Listening Skills

Instructions: Active listening is key to understanding others, especially across cultures. Answer the following questions with 2-3 sentences each.

- **Full Focus:** Why is giving your full attention (no distractions) important when listening to someone from a different cultural background? Give an example from the chapter or your life.
- **Ask Open Questions:** Write one open-ended question you could ask a classmate about a cultural tradition (e.g., a holiday like Diwali or Ramadan) to show curiosity and encourage them to share more.

Mini-Activity: Pair up with a classmate (or imagine a convo). Share a 1-minute story about a cultural moment in your life. Practice active listening by reflecting back (e.g., "It sounds like...") and asking an open question. Write down one thing you learned about their story.

What I Learned: _____

Part 4: Overcoming Language Barriers

Instructions: Language differences don't have to stop communication. Reflect on strategies from the chapter by answering the questions below with 2-3 sentences each.

- **Simplify Language:** How can simplifying your words help when talking to someone who isn't fluent in your language? Describe a situation where this could work.
- **Use Technology or Non-Verbal Cues:** What's one non-verbal way (like gestures) or tech tool (like Google Translate) you could use to bridge a language gap? Have you tried something like this before?

Creative Task: Imagine you're at a school event and meet an exchange student who speaks little English. Draw or describe a quick gesture or sketch (e.g., pointing to a soccer ball) you'd use to invite them to join a game.

Description or Sketch: (Use the space below or continue on the back if needed.)

Part 5: Cross-Cultural Communication Scenario

Instructions: Read the scenario below and answer the questions to apply what you've learned.

Scenario: You're working on a group project with an Indian classmate (high-context culture) and an American classmate (low-context culture). The Indian student hints, "Maybe we should look at this section again," while the American student says, "This part isn't done right, let's fix it now." You notice tension because they're not understanding each other's styles.

- How might the Indian student's hint be misinterpreted by the American student? (2-3 sentences)
- What active listening technique could you use to clarify both their intentions and ease the tension? (2-3 sentences)

Part 6: Critical Thinking Question

Instructions: Answer the following question in 3-5 sentences to reflect on the importance of communication skills in a diverse world.

How can improving your communication skills across cultures (like active listening or adapting to context) help you in school, friendships, or future careers? Use an example from the chapter or your own ideas.

Part 7: Fun Challenge – "Cross-Cultural Chat Badge"

Instructions: Design a small badge (draw or describe it) that represents your new communication skills from this chapter. Include symbols or words for at least two concepts (e.g., a speech bubble for active listening, a head bobble for non-verbal cues). Use the space below or a separate paper if needed.

Badge Design or Description: